

Maria Silva

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I am applying for the Family Paralegal role at your Marlow firm, advertised through Reed. With a law degree from UCL, an LLM in Dispute Resolution from Queen Mary, and current front-line experience advising clients on family, housing, employment and welfare matters at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, I am well positioned to support your senior fee earners across a varied private family caseload from day one.

At Citizens Advice, I conduct detailed client interviews on family matters, take factual statements, establish chronologies and identify the legal and evidential issues that shape each case. I manage files from initial instruction through to submission: drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules, maintaining confidential records and meeting deadlines. I regularly translate complex procedural rules into clear, practical guidance for clients in difficult personal circumstances — exactly the client-focused approach private family work demands.

During my year at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, I supported hearing preparation across both international arbitration and real estate disputes: reviewing documents, preparing electronic bundles, assisting with skeleton arguments and tracking procedural deadlines across several matters simultaneously. A partner and associate noted that my performance was comparable to that of a newly qualified solicitor. That experience gave me a grounding in file discipline, court procedures and working effectively under pressure that translates directly into supporting fee earners on a busy family caseload.

I am drawn to this role because it offers genuine hands-on responsibility within a supportive team, and the opportunity to develop a long-term career in private practice. Your firm's reputation in the Marlow area and the breadth of the family caseload make this a particularly strong fit with where I want to build my practice.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your consideration.

Maria Fernanda Silva